
Topic 7: Child psychology

Topic overview

Students must show understanding that child psychology is about the development of the individual from before birth to adolescence and beyond, in that what we experience as children affects our later development.

Individual differences and developmental psychology must be considered when learning about differences that can come from the child's age, gender, social situation, privation and deprivation.

Subject content	What students need to learn:
7.1 Content	Attachment, deprivation and privation
	7.1.1 Bowlby's work on attachment.
	7.1.2 Ainsworth's work on attachment, including types of attachment and the Strange Situation procedure.
	7.1.3 Research into deprivation (short-term and long-term effects) and how negative effects can be reduced.
	7.1.4 Research into privation and whether the negative effects can be reversed.
	7.1.5 Research into day care, including advantages and disadvantages for the child, and what makes good and poor-quality day care.
	7.1.6 Cross-cultural research into attachment types and nature-nurture issues that arise about development.
	7.1.7 Autism • The features of autism. • One biological explanation for autism. • One other explanation for autism. • Therapies for helping children with autism.
	7.1.8 Individual differences • Attachment type can affect individuals differently, such as issues of child temperament. • Positive and negative aspects of day care can be affected by individual differences such as gender or temperament.
	7.1.9 Developmental psychology • Effects on development of day care. • Effects on development of attachment interactions, including deprivation, privation and separation.